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Unit 4

Supplementary

With the Photographer

Stephen Leacock

Warm Up

Photographs capture memorable moments. They fill us with nostalgia.

Discuss the following questions.

1. What are the occasions when photographs are taken?

e.g. birthday parties	

2. Why are photographs taken?

e.g. to freeze our favourite moments	

Here is a story 'With the Photographer' where the narrator visits a studio to have his photograph taken. His experience with the professional photographer turns out to be an unforgettable one.

"I want my photograph taken," I said. The photographer looked at me without enthusiasm. He was a **drooping** man in a gray suit, with the dim eye of a natural scientist. But there is no need to describe him. Everybody knows what a photographer is like.

"Sit there," he said, "and wait."

I waited an hour. I read *the Ladies Companion* for 1912, *the Girls Magazine* for 1902 and *the Infants Journal* for 1888. I began to see that I had done an **unwarrantable** thing in breaking in on the privacy of this man's scientific **pursuits** with a face like mine.

After an hour the photographer opened the inner door.

"Come in," he said severely.

I went into the studio.

"Sit down," said the photographer.

I sat down in a beam of sunlight filtered through a sheet of factory cotton hung against a frosted skylight.

The photographer rolled a machine into the middle of the room and crawled into it from behind.

He was only in it a second,–just time enough for one look at me,–and then he was out again, tearing at the cotton sheet and the window panes with a hooked stick, apparently **frantic** for light and air.